Website Cutover — IT Handoff

Site: cliffcomortgage.com **From:** WordPress on `167.172.234.163` (nginx) **To:** Vercel (Astro, server-rendered)
Prepared: 2026-10-13

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1. What you actually need to do

Short version: **change two DNS records.** Everything else is already configured in the application or in Vercel.

The 144 old-URL redirects are **built into the application**, not into nginx, Apache or a DNS service. You do not need to build a redirect map, import a CSV, or configure rules anywhere. `launch/redirects.csv` is included only so you can verify them after cutover.

THING	WHO HANDLES IT
DNS A / CNAME records	**You**
TTL lowering before cutover	**You**
TLS certificate	Vercel, automatic
301 redirects (144)	Already in the app
Security headers (HSTS, CSP, etc.)	Already in `website/vercel.json`
`robots.txt` and sitemaps	Generated at build
Environment variables	Marketing, in Vercel (see §4)

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2. DNS changes

Registrar / DNS host: Network Solutions (`ns93.worldnic.com` , `ns94.worldnic.com`)

Current

HOST	TYPE	VALUE	TTL
`cliffcomortgage.com`	A	`167.172.234.163`	3600
`www.cliffcomortgage.com`	A	`167.172.234.163`	3600

`www` currently returns a 301 to the apex. Keep that behaviour.

Target

HOST	TYPE	VALUE
`cliffcomortgage.com`	A	`216.198.79.1`
`www.cliffcomortgage.com`	CNAME	project-specific — read it from the Vercel dashboard

The apex A record above is verified: it is what cliffcomn.com, already live on Vercel in this same account, resolves to today. Older Vercel documentation says `76.76.21.21` and many third-party guides still repeat it; that is not what this account is issued.

The www CNAME cannot be looked up or guessed. Vercel issues a different one per project — cliffcomn.com's is `e9df9d2cb823d9d2.vercel-dns-017.com`, and cliffcomortgage.com will get its own distinct hostname. Add the domain in **Project → Settings → Domains** first and copy the CNAME value Vercel displays there. Using another project's CNAME will serve the wrong site.

Do this first, 24–48h ahead

Lower both records' TTL from 3600 to **300**. This is the single thing that makes a rollback fast. At TTL 3600 a bad cutover takes an hour to undo; at 300 it takes five minutes.

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3. ⚠️ Records that must NOT change

This domain carries live company email and marketing email. Changing the web records is safe. Changing or removing anything below will break mail delivery company-wide.

Leave exactly as-is:

- **MX** — `d354483a.ess.barracudanetworks.com` and `d354483b.ess.barracudanetworks.com`

(Barracuda Email Security, in front of Microsoft 365)

- **SPF TXT** — currently:

`` `v=spf1 include:spf.protection.outlook.com include:spf.exclaimer.net include:spf.ess.barracudanetworks.com include:servers.mcsv.net include:sendgrid.net include:21616430.spf02.hubspotemail.net ip4:52.249.26.186 ~all` `` That single line authorises Microsoft 365, Exclaimer signatures, Barracuda, Mailchimp, SendGrid and HubSpot. Dropping it silently sends company and marketing mail to spam.

- **DKIM / DMARC** — any `_domainkey` or `_dmarc` records
- **`google-site-verification=zXRHoNKBUPwjTM5rXe_1LiQVVatGnMQzgez3YA0vnNw`** — this is the

Search Console verification. Removing it drops the property and all its history.

- **`sophos-domain-verification=…`**
- Any other subdomain records not listed in §2

If the plan is to move nameservers rather than edit records, every record above has to be recreated at the new provider first. Editing the two A records in place is lower risk, and is what this document assumes.

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4. Environment variables (Vercel)

Set in **Project → Settings → Environment Variables**, ticked for **Production, Preview and Development**. Marketing holds the values; IT does not need them unless asked to enter them.

VARIABLE	PURPOSE	SECRET
`SMTP2GO_API_KEY`	Sends lead notification email	Yes
`EMAIL_FROM`	From address on notifications	No
`HUBSPOT_PORTAL_ID`	HubSpot portal	No
`HUBSPOT_FORM_GUID`	Lead intake form	No
`HUBSPOT_TOKEN`	Dashboard CRM reads	Yes
`DASHBOARD_PASSWORD`	Gate on `/dashboard/`	Yes
`PUBLIC_POSTHOG_KEY`	Product analytics	No
`PUBLIC_POSTHOG_HOST`	Product analytics	No
`GOOGLE_ADS_DEVELOPER_TOKEN`	Dashboard ad reporting	Yes
`GOOGLE_ADS_CLIENT_ID`	"	No
`GOOGLE_ADS_CLIENT_SECRET`	"	Yes
`GOOGLE_ADS_REFRESH_TOKEN`	"	Yes
`GOOGLE_ADS_LOGIN_CUSTOMER_ID`	"	No
`GOOGLE_ADS_CUSTOMER_ID`	"	No
`INDEXNOW_SUBMIT`	Set to `true` for production only	No

If a variable is missing at build time, the related feature fails silently — forms stop sending, or `/dashboard/` opens with no password. Confirm all are present before cutover.

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5. Cutover sequence

1. **48h before** — lower TTL on both A records to 300.

2. **Day of** — add `cliffcomortgage.com` and `www.cliffcomortgage.com` in Vercel under Project → Settings → Domains. Vercel will show "Invalid Configuration" until DNS points at it; that is expected. **Copy the www CNAME value it displays — that is the only place it exists.**
3. Change the two DNS records to the values from §2.
4. Wait for propagation (5–15 min at TTL 300). Check with `nslookup cliffcomortgage.com 8.8.8.8`.
5. Vercel issues the TLS certificate automatically once DNS resolves — usually under a minute. No CSR, no manual certificate.
6. Run the checks in §6.
7. **Leave the old WordPress server running for 7 days.** It costs nothing and it is the rollback.
8. After 7 clean days, restore TTL to 3600.

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6. Post-cutover checks

```
# 1. Apex and www both resolve to Vercel and serve 200 / 301
curl -sI https://cliffcomortgage.com/      | head -1     # expect 200
curl -sI https://www.cliffcomortgage.com/  | head -1     # expect 301 to apex

# 2. TLS is valid and issued by Vercel
curl -sI https://cliffcomortgage.com/ | grep -i strict-transport-security

# 3. Spot-check redirects (full list in launch/redirects.csv)
curl -sI https://cliffcomortgage.com/loans/fix-and-flip/ | grep -i location
curl -sI https://cliffcomortgage.com/loan-officers/ralvarez/ | grep -i location

# 4. Sitemap and robots resolve
curl -s https://cliffcomortgage.com/sitemap-index.xml | head -2
curl -s https://cliffcomortgage.com/robots.txt | head -3

# 5. Email still flows — send a test to and from a @cliffcomortgage.com address
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Marketing will separately submit a live form and confirm the lead reaches HubSpot and the notification email arrives.

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7. Rollback

Change the two A records back to `167.172.234.163`. At TTL 300 the old site is serving again within ~5 minutes. Nothing else needs undoing — the WordPress install is untouched by any of the above.

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8. Files in this handoff

FILE	WHAT IT IS
`IT-HANDOFF.md`	This document
`redirects.csv`	All 144 old → new paths, all 301. For verification only — already built into the app
`sitemap-urls.txt`	All 196 live URLs, one per line. For bulk crawling / link checking

Live sitemap after cutover: `https://cliffcomortgage.com/sitemap-index.xml`

9. Marketing's side (not IT)

Listed so nothing falls between the two teams:

- Submit the new sitemap in Google Search Console (the existing property stays valid, since

the verification TXT is unchanged)

- Confirm a live test lead reaches HubSpot and triggers the notification email
- Turn on Enhanced Conversions in Google Ads
- Point any ad campaigns at the new URLs if they target pages that moved